

## Chapter 23 — Clause Analysis Drill

BBH Chapter 23

For each clause: (a) Clause type (Verbal VSO / Verbal — fronted / Verbless / Waw-disjunctive / Circumstantial), (b) Main verb and conjugation (if any), (c) Fronted element (if any) and why, (d) Full English gloss.

### Part A — Verbal Clauses: Default VSO (1–4)

| #       | Hebrew                               | Clause Type | Verb & Conjugation | Subject | Object/Predicate | Gloss |
|---------|--------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------|---------|------------------|-------|
| ( 1:27) | וַיִּבְרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת־הָאָדָם׃     |             |                    |         |                  |       |
| ( 3:7)  | וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מִשְׁה׃         |             |                    |         |                  |       |
|         | שָׁמַעַן בְּנִי יִשְׂרָאֵל ( 6:4 ) 3 |             |                    |         |                  |       |
| ( 1:4)  | וַיִּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֶת־הָאוֹר׃        |             |                    |         |                  |       |

### Part B — Fronted Elements (5–8)

| #       | Hebrew                                    | What is fronted? | Type of element | Why fronted? | Gloss |
|---------|-------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------------|--------------|-------|
| 5       | הַיּוֹם יִלְדְּתִי ( 2:7 )                |                  |                 |              |       |
|         | וְאֶלְקִינָן ... לֹא שָׁעָה ( 4:5 )       |                  |                 |              |       |
| ( 12:7) | אֶת־הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת אֶתְנֶנָּה...         |                  |                 |              |       |
| ( 1:27) | בְּצִלְמִם אֱלֹהִים בָּרָא אֹתָם ( 1:27 ) |                  |                 |              |       |

### Part C — Verbless Clauses (9–12)

| #  | Hebrew                               | Subject | Predicate | Implied Copula | Gloss |
|----|--------------------------------------|---------|-----------|----------------|-------|
|    | יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ יְהוָה אֶחָד (9:4) |         |           |                |       |
| 10 | טוֹב הָאוֹר ( 1:4 )                  |         |           |                |       |
| 11 | אֲנִכִּי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ ( 20:2 )   |         |           |                |       |
| 12 | הָשֹׁמֵר אֶחָד אֲנִכִּי ( 4:9 )      |         |           |                |       |

### Part D — Waw-Disjunctive and Circumstantial (13–16)

| #  | Hebrew                                           | First element after | Function | Relation to main narrative | Gloss |
|----|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------|----------|----------------------------|-------|
| 13 | וְהָאֲרֶץ הָיְתָה תֹהוֹ ( 1:2 )                  |                     |          |                            |       |
| 14 | וְהָיָה יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּתֹחַ ( 18:1 )              |                     |          |                            |       |
| 15 | וְהָיָה נֶחֱשׁ הָיָה עָרוֹם ( 3:1 )              |                     |          |                            |       |
| 16 | וְהָיָה לֹא יָדַע כִּי יְהוָה עֲזָבֹהּ ( 16:20 ) |                     |          |                            |       |

### Part E — Mixed Analysis (17–20)

| #  | Hebrew                                   | Clause Type | Special Feature | Gloss |
|----|------------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------|-------|
| 17 | בְּרָא אֱלֹהִים ... ( 1:1 )              |             |                 |       |
| 18 | הָיָה אֲנֹכִי שָׁלֵחַ מִלֶּאךָ ( 23:20 ) |             |                 |       |
| 19 | וְאַהֲבַתְּ אֶת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ ( 6:5 ) |             |                 |       |
| 20 | כִּי אֵין אֱלֹהִים זֹלָתִי ( 32:39 )     |             |                 |       |

### Answer Key — Part A

| #        | Hebrew                             | Clause Type | Verb & Conjugation | Subject           | Object/Predicate | Gloss                      |
|----------|------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------|-------------------|------------------|----------------------------|
| ( 1:27 ) | וַיִּבְרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת־הָאָדָם    |             |                    |                   |                  |                            |
| ✓        | וַיִּבְרָא אֱלֹהִים ...            | Verbal VSO  | וַיִּבְרָא         | אֱלֹהִים          | אֶת־הָאָדָם      | And God created man        |
| ( 3:1 )  | וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה        |             |                    |                   |                  |                            |
| ✓        | וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה ...               | Verbal VSO  | וַיֹּאמֶר          | יְהוָה            | אֶל־מֹשֶׁה       | And the LORD said to Moses |
| 3        | שָׁמַעַן בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל ( 6:4 ) |             |                    |                   |                  |                            |
| ✓        | שָׁמַעַן בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל         | Verbal VSO  | שָׁמַעַן           | בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל | —                | Hear, O Israel             |
| ( 1:4 )  | וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת־הָאוֹר       |             |                    |                   |                  |                            |
| ✓        | וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים ...              | Verbal VSO  | וַיֵּרָא           | אֱלֹהִים          | אֶת־הָאוֹר       | And God saw the light      |

### Answer Key — Part B

| #        | Hebrew                            | What is fronted? | Type of element | Why fronted?                 | Gloss                          |
|----------|-----------------------------------|------------------|-----------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| 5        | הַיּוֹם יֵלֶדְתִּי ( 2:7 )        |                  |                 |                              |                                |
| ✓        | הַיּוֹם יֵלֶדְתִּי                | ■■■/■■■■■■■      | Temporal        | Emphatic: Today (not         | Today I have begotten you      |
|          | וְאֶלְקִין ... לֹא שָׁעָה ( 4:5 ) |                  |                 |                              |                                |
| ✓        | וְאֶלְקִין ... לֹא שָׁעָה         | ■■■■■■■■■■■      | Prepositional   | Contrast: to Cain (vs. Abel) | But to Cain he did not pay     |
| ( 12:7 ) | אֶתְּהָאֶרֶץ הַזֹּאת אֶתֶּן ...   |                  |                 |                              |                                |
| ✓        | אֶתְּהָאֶרֶץ ... אֶתֶּן           | ■■■■■■■/■■■■■■■  | Object          | Emphasis on object: *This    | This land I will give to your  |
| ( 1:27 ) | בְּצֶלֶם אֱלֹהִים בָּרָא אֱתָן    |                  |                 |                              |                                |
| ✓        | בְּצֶלֶם אֱלֹהִים ...             | ■■■/■■■■■■■      | Prepositional   | Chiastic emphasis: the image | In the image of God he created |

### Answer Key — Part C

| #  | Hebrew                               | Subject   | Predicate      | Implied Copula | Gloss                                |
|----|--------------------------------------|-----------|----------------|----------------|--------------------------------------|
|    | יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ יְהוָה אֶחָד (9:6) |           |                |                |                                      |
| ✓  | יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ ...                | ■■■■■■■   | ■■■■■■■■■■■ is |                | The LORD is our God; the LORD is one |
| 10 | טוֹב הָאוֹר ( 1:4 )                  |           |                |                |                                      |
| ✓  | טוֹב הָאוֹר                          | ■■■/■■■■■ | ■■■■■ (pred.   | was            | The light was good                   |
| 11 | אֲנִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ ( 20:2 )      |           |                |                |                                      |
| ✓  | אֲנִי יְהוָה ...                     | ■■■■■■■   | ■■■■■■■        | am             | I am the LORD your God               |
| 12 | הֲשֹׁמֵר אֲחִי אֲנִי ( 4:9 )         |           |                |                |                                      |
| ✓  | הֲשֹׁמֵר אֲחִי אֲנִי                 | ■■■■■■■   | ■■■■■■■        | am             | Am I my brother's keeper?            |

### Answer Key — Part D

| #         | Hebrew                                | First element after | Relation       | Relation to main narrative | Gloss                                |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|---------------------|----------------|----------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| 13        | וְהָאָרֶץ הִיְתָה תֹהוֹ ( 1:2 )       |                     |                |                            |                                      |
| ✓         | וְהָאָרֶץ הִיְתָה ...                 | ■■■/■■■■■■■         | Background     | Off-narrative; sets scene  | Now the earth was formless and       |
| 14        | וְהָיָא יֹשֵׁב פֶּתַח ( 18:1 )        |                     |                |                            |                                      |
| ✓         | וְהָיָא יֹשֵׁב ...                    | ■■■■■ + ptc.        | Simultaneous   | What Abraham was doing     | while he was sitting at the entrance |
| 15        | וְהַנָּחֹשׁ הָיָה עָרוֹם ( 3:1 )      |                     |                |                            |                                      |
| ✓         | וְהַנָּחֹשׁ ...                       | ■■■/■■■■■■■         | Background     | Introduces serpent before  | Now the serpent was more crafty      |
| ( 16:20 ) | וְהָיָא לֹא יָדַע כִּי יְהוָה עָזְבוֹ |                     |                |                            |                                      |
| ✓         | וְהָיָא לֹא יָדַע ...                 | ■■■■■               | Contrast/irony | Contrasts Samson's action  | but he did not know the LORD had     |

## Answer Key — Part E

| #  | Hebrew                                   | Clause Type | Special Feature                | Gloss                            |
|----|------------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 17 | בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים ... (1:1)    |             |                                |                                  |
| ✓  | בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים ...          | Verbal — PP | Temporal PP ■■■■/■■■■■■■■■■    | In the beginning God created the |
| 18 | הִנֵּה אֲנִכִּי שֹׁלֵחַ מַלְאָךְ (23:20) |             |                                |                                  |
| ✓  | הִנֵּה אֲנִכִּי שֹׁלֵחַ ...              | Verbless /  | ■■■■■ + pronoun + participle = | Behold, I am sending an angel    |
| 19 | וְאַהֲבַתְּ אֶת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ (6:5)   |             |                                |                                  |
| ✓  | וְאַהֲבַתְּ אֶת יְהוָה ...               | Verbal —    | Weqatal continues imperatival  | And you shall love the LORD your |
| 20 | כִּי אֵין אֱלֹהִים זולָתִי (32:39)       |             |                                |                                  |
| ✓  | כִּי אֵין אֱלֹהִים ...                   | Verbless /  | ■■■■ = non-existence particle; | For there is no God besides me   |